

PRD - VibeHaus

Your vibe. Your people. Your city.

Author: Sakshi · Status: capston · Date: 26 August 2026

1. Product & context

VibeHaus is an AI-powered friendship-discovery app that helps expats, newcomers, and locals in Berlin find people they genuinely connect with — and turn those connections into real-life friendships through chat, coffee, and activities. It matches on interests, personality, and social energy (not appearance), recommends people as personality-first cards with a **banded, explained "Vibe Match,"** and follows one product principle: **increasing intimacy requires increasing consent.** Solo capstone MVP, built mobile-first via Lovable; Berlin-first, brand designed to travel to other cities.

Navigation: Discover · Events · **My Haus** (Vibemates · Chats, with a "Pending Requests" count) · Profile. A **Calendar** (accessed via a header icon on every tab) surfaces upcoming and pending Coffee/Activity Vibes and Events in one place.

Design approach: mobile-first — the app is designed and built primarily for phone-sized screens, since that's how people would actually use VibeHaus day to day. Note this is a **mobile-first responsive web app** (built in Lovable), not a native iOS/Android app — true native apps are a separate, larger undertaking and sit on the roadmap as **Epic J2, Future** (see backlog).

Core flow:

Sign up → Onboarding (interests → social energy → friendship intent) → Discover Vibe Matches → open profile + "Why You Might Vibe" → **Like** (a private signal) → prompt: **Send Vibemate Request** (sends it) or **Maybe Later** (saves the profile to **Saved Vibes** instead, no request sent) → if a request was sent, recipient Accepts/Declines → **Vibemates** → auto-added to **My Haus** → **Chat** unlocks automatically; **Coffee Vibe / Activity Vibe** can then be suggested (each still needs its own accept/decline, and either party can cancel a confirmed one afterward). This graduated model — private signal → mutual request → relationship → engagement mode — replaces a direct chat/coffee/activity "reach-out," so no contact of any kind happens before both people have chosen each other.

User Journey:



Profile screens use one of three states, checked live every time a profile is opened (never cached): **(1) Already Vibemates** — full profile with Chat, Coffee Vibe, Activity Vibe, Remove, and Block/Report; **(2) Pending** (a Vibemate Request sent or received, not yet decided) — full profile with Accept/Decline (incoming) or a plain "Pending, awaiting their response" status (outgoing), no engagement actions yet; **(3) Not connected** — full profile with just Like/Save.

Beyond the core loop, the MVP also includes two features originally scoped as stretch/roadmap items, both fully built during the sprint:

- **Events** — create a public or private "Vibe" (activity + date/time + optional venue/description), with public events offering either "Open to all" (join instantly) or "Permission based" (host approves/declines) modes, plus direct invites by name for public events and roster-only invites for private ones. Hosts can Cancel; attendees can Leave. Events feed into Calendar alongside Coffee/Activity Vibes.
- **Mr. Vibe** — a floating assistant on Discover that helps find people for a specific activity or energy, via a guided, chip-based conversation (see §11 for the AI architecture and why free-text input was intentionally disabled).

2. Problem statement

Making real friends as an adult — especially after moving to a new city — is hard. The problem isn't a lack of people; it's a lack of *fit* and the risk of the first move: you can't tell whether someone else wants to connect, so reaching out feels "clingy," and casual meetups rarely become lasting friendships.

There's also a **connection-mode problem**: existing tools force a single path. Dating-style apps match you and drop you into a one-to-one chat that can feel like an awkward, interview-like exchange; group-event tools ask you to walk into a room of strangers, which is its own kind of pressure. People connect differently — some build trust slowly through messages (especially introverts), others would rather skip the small talk and simply *do something together*. The unmet need is a low-pressure way to meet that lets each person **choose their own on-ramp — chat, coffee, or a shared activity**.

Scoping honesty: the *user outcome* is lasting friendship, but that's outside any app's direct control. VibeHaus's *job* is achievable — **better introductions and an easier first connection**. We design for the outcome and measure the job.

3. User persona (proto-persona)

Newcomer Nadia (*hypothesis-based, informed by early discovery; to be validated with further interviews*). 30s, expat in Berlin 0–3 years, basic German, ambivert. A few acquaintances but only 1–2 she'd genuinely choose. Open to activities but finds cold in-person approaches draining; prefers to message first. Wants *meaningful* friendships, worries it might "feel like dating."

- **Goals**: find people she vibes with; connect at her own pace; do real things together.
- **Pains**: poor fit / settling; fear of the first move; casual meets that don't stick; depth without huge effort.

Secondary: newcomers and locals seeking deeper connection — expat-first, not expat-only.

4. Jobs To Be Done

- When I've moved somewhere new, I want to find people I genuinely click with, so that I build real friendships, not just acquaintances.
- When I want to reach out, I want to know they're also open to it, so that I don't feel clingy.
- When I meet someone promising, I want a low-pressure way to signal interest before contacting them, so that liking someone doesn't put me on the hook to message right away.
- Once we're mutually connected, I want to choose how we engage (chat, coffee, or an activity), so that it fits my comfort.
- As an ambivert, I want to message first, so that trust can build before meeting.

5. User insight (summary → decisions)

From 1 founder-as-user interview + 3 survey responses (small, directional, expat-skewed — stated as a limitation):

- **Depth, not access** was the recurring pain → match on fit/personality, not proximity.
- **Signalled mutual intent** was the sharpest insight → Like is private, and a separate Vibemate Request (with mutual accept) gates all contact — no chat/coffee/activity happens before both people opt in.
- **2 of 3 who tried existing tools found they fell short** → differentiate on fit + lasting connection, not volume.
- **All 3 preferred curated groups/activities over profile-browsing** → a scrollable feed with private like/save (scrolling past is how you skip, no explicit "dislike") instead of swiping; Events built into the MVP.
- **AI interest lukewarm** → AI present but explained and optional; earns its place via the *explained match*, not hype.

External evidence (secondary research — validates the problem's scale):

- **Berlin, our triggers:** citing a 2024 Techniker Krankenkasse survey, **68% of people aged 18–39 in Germany report experiencing loneliness**, often tied to *living alone, moving cities, or changing jobs* (foreveryone.berlin, 2025).
- **Making friends here is hard for newcomers:** InterNations ranked **Germany 47th of 58** for making friends; **~39% of expats in Germany are mainly friends with other expats** (iamexpat.de / InterNations).
- **Young-adult loneliness is widespread and persistent: 51% of young German adults (18–35) are at least moderately lonely** (Bertelsmann Stiftung, 2024); **1 in 5 aged 21–30 feel very lonely** (Germany's BiB, 2024–25).
- *Honest limit:* this validates the **problem**, not our specific **solution** (AI matching + chat/coffee/activity) — that still needs primary validation. (*Sources with links in the discovery report, §4b.*)

6. Competitor analysis

- **Bumble BFF** — profile + swipe; broad but appearance-led, low on fit/intent.
- **Meetup** — interest groups; great for events, weak on compatibility.
- **Timeleft** — curated group dinners; strong IRL, not about ongoing 1:1 friendship.
- **InterNations** — largest expat network; event/community-first, no fit-matching engine.

Positioning: where others are swipe-first, event-first, or community-first, **VibeHaus is fit-first** — matches on interests + personality + social energy, *explains* why you'd vibe, and requires mutual opt-in so reaching out feels safe. Expat-first; activities/events on the roadmap. (*Full comparison table in the discovery report.*)

7. Scope & requirements

MVP — Must have (built):

- Auth (sign up / log in, with email verification).

- **Onboarding:** interests · social energy (chill / balanced / bring-the-energy) · friendship intent · connection preference.
- **Profile:** personality-first; optional fields (languages, hometown/country, new-in-town). Three relationship-based display states (§1), checked live on every open.
- **Vibe Match discovery:** attribute-based compatibility (weighting shared interests · social energy · intent · availability · connection preference, **plus light expat-aware signals: newcomer status leans toward fellow newcomers, and shared language/hometown gives a soft boost**), surfaced as cards with a **banded Vibe Score + short "why you might vibe"** listing every genuinely shared interest, generated by an LLM (never an unexplained precise %); like / bookmark (save), with a sticky filter row (All / Strong / Good / Potential / Saved Vibe) and a working name search.
- **Vibemate Requests:** Like is a private signal; a separate prompt offers **Send Vibemate Request** (sends it) or **Maybe Later** (saves the profile to Saved Vibes instead, no request sent); if sent, recipient Accepts/Declines; Accept creates a **Vibemate** relationship, auto-added to **My Haus**, and shows a "Say Hi!" prompt with Chat/Coffee/Activity options.
- **Communication: Chat** unlocks automatically for Vibemates, with the Vibemate's photo and a tappable name in the header; optional **newcomer-aware AI Icebreaker; Coffee Vibe / Activity Vibe** (required date/time, optional venue with a static map preview, optional note) can be suggested within the relationship, each with its own accept/decline, and **either party can cancel a confirmed one, from the chat or Calendar**; a "Delete Chat" option clears message history only, without ending the Vibemate relationship.
- **Events (built, not a placeholder):** create a public or private "Vibe" (activity, date/time, optional venue/description). Public events choose **"Open to all"** (join instantly) or **"Permission based"** (host approves/declines), plus direct invites by name; private events invite only from the host's own Vibemates roster. Hosts can **Cancel Vibe** (from the main list or Calendar); attendees can **Leave Event** (host is notified). Feeds into Calendar.
- **Calendar (built):** a header icon on every tab opens "Upcoming (Confirmed)" and "Pending" views merging Coffee/Activity Vibes and Events (joined, hosted — labeled "Hosting" — and requested/invited), with every person's name tappable to their live-state profile.
- **Mr. Vibe (built):** a floating assistant, Discover-only, helping find people for a specific activity via a guided chip-based conversation (activity chips → social-energy chips → matched profiles, with an honest, consent-based "no match" fallback). See §11 for why this is chip-only, not free-text.
- **Safety: block · report · remove Vibemate;** community guidelines; no contact of any kind before mutual Vibemate acceptance; removing a Vibemate immediately and consistently revokes Chat/Coffee/Activity access everywhere their profile can be viewed.
- **Profile header:** Edit / Settings (Delete Account functional; Theme and Subscription are visual placeholders) / Logout.

Out of scope (roadmap): advanced AI learning / a trained recommender, live map integration (currently a static preview), real identity verification (a "Verified" badge is deliberately not shown,

to avoid implying a check that isn't performed), push notifications, event chat, group matching, gamification, native apps, a fully free-text/live-generative Mr. Vibe.

Two-tier events & monetization model (Future, not MVP): "Create a Vibe" (casual, user-generated meetups) stays **free for everyone, always** — don't charge people to make friends. **VibeHaus Hosted Experiences** (official, curated) are **included for VibeHaus+ (premium) members; free users purchase individually**. This is where paid events live, kept separate from peer meetups. *(Full acceptance criteria in the backlog.)*

8. Success metrics

VibeHaus measures whether the MVP helps users move from discovering someone compatible → expressing intent → mutually connecting → making a confirmed plan to meet in real life. The MVP does not attempt to measure whether a lasting friendship was ultimately formed, as that outcome happens outside the product and over a longer period.

MVP Success Criteria

Metric	Definition	How it's measured	What "good" looks like for MVP
★ Confirmed IRL Connection Rate (North Star)	% of accepted Vibemate connections that progress to a mutually accepted Coffee Vibe or Activity Vibe	Vibemate connections with ≥1 accepted Coffee/Activity Vibe ÷ total accepted Vibemate connections × 100	≥20% (directional hypothesis to validate)
Vibemate Acceptance Rate	% of sent Vibemate Requests that are accepted, indicating interest and perceived fit are mutual	Accepted Vibemate Requests ÷ total Vibemate Requests sent × 100	≥40% (directional hypothesis to validate)
Match Relevance	Whether users perceive their recommended Vibe Matches as genuinely relevant	Short post-test rating: "How relevant did your Vibe Matches feel?" (1–5 scale)	≥70% of testers rate 4 or 5 (directional)

Targets are MVP validation thresholds, not established industry benchmarks — they define initial success for Alpha/Beta and should be revised once VibeHaus collects real behavioral data.

The North Star deliberately measures a **confirmed intention to meet**, not a verified physical meetup. Coffee and Activity Vibes require a separate accept/decline action after two users have already mutually become Vibemates, making the outcome directly observable within the product — unlike a message-count threshold, which would require an arbitrary, hard-to-justify cutoff.

MVP KPIs (trace the journey toward the success criteria, identify funnel drop-off)

KPI	Definition / Calculation	What it helps us understand
Activation Rate	% of new users who complete onboarding and engage with ≥ 1 Vibe Match through Like, Save, or Vibemate Request	Whether new users reach and engage with VibeHaus's core value proposition. Target $\geq 60\%$ (directional)
Vibemate Request Rate	Users who send ≥ 1 Vibemate Request $\div$ Activated Users $\times 100$	Whether users who reach Discover find someone relevant enough to take the first step toward connecting
Vibemate Acceptance Rate	Accepted Vibemate Requests $\div$ Vibemate Requests sent $\times 100$	Whether interest is mutual and recommendations lead to viable connections
★ Confirmed IRL Connection Rate	Vibemate connections with ≥ 1 accepted Coffee/Activity Vibe $\div$ accepted Vibemate connections $\times 100$	Whether mutual connections progress toward the intended real-world outcome
D7 Retention	% of new users who return seven days after signup	Whether early users find enough ongoing value to return (primarily evaluated once the product reaches Beta with real users over time)

Core MVP Funnel: Sign-up $\rightarrow$ Activated User $\rightarrow$ Vibemate Request $\rightarrow$ Accepted Vibemate $\rightarrow$ Confirmed Coffee/Activity Vibe.

Drop-off between each stage should be monitored to locate where the connection journey breaks down. A high Like rate but low Vibemate Request Rate suggests friction making the first move; a healthy Request Rate but low Acceptance Rate suggests a relevance or mutual-fit problem instead.

Supporting & Guardrail Measures

Chat Start Rate can be tracked diagnostically (% of Vibemate connections with ≥ 1 message sent), but message frequency is not used to define a successful or meaningful connection — users can choose Chat, Coffee Vibe, or Activity Vibe once they're Vibemates, consistent with VibeHaus's JTBD. Events and Mr. Vibe engagement are supporting product-learning metrics, not MVP success criteria. Safety is a release guardrail, not a KPI: Block, Report, and Remove Vibemate must function reliably, with no unresolved critical safety defects before progressing to a broader release — these controls are explicitly part of the MVP.

Later-stage metrics (not part of MVP validation): D30 Retention, Free-to-Paid Conversion, MRR, ARPU, churn, and Hosted Experience revenue — relevant once VibeHaus moves from validation into retention, scale, and monetization (Phase 4).

9. Risks & dependencies

- **Cold-start / two-sided:** empty app is useless → seed 8–12 profiles; usability test.
- **Founder-as-user + small, expat-skewed sample:** stated openly; next step diverse interviews.
- **AI value unproven / lukewarm:** filter-only fallback; AI explained and optional.
- **"Feels like dating" trap:** platonic-first copy, intent selector, no romantic framing.
- **Mr. Vibe's free-text risk, resolved by simplifying:** initial testing found free-text intent-parsing unreliable (mismatched results); rather than debug live-parsing risk under time pressure, we deliberately disabled free text and expanded the chip set to cover the app's full interest list — a safer trade of some flexibility for reliability, consistent with our "explained, not opaque" AI stance.
- **Safety:** strangers meet offline → block/report/remove in MVP; verification and moderation on the roadmap.

10. Privacy & security (MVP level)

- Optional fields (languages, hometown/country, new-in-town) are **optional, self-declared, and never a hard filter**. No sensitive/protected attributes (e.g. ethnicity) are collected in the MVP.
- **Safety in MVP:** block, report, remove Vibemate; chat only unlocks between mutually-accepted Vibemates; community guidelines. (*Identity verification is deliberately **not** in the MVP — a "Verified" badge would imply a check that isn't performed; it's on the Next roadmap.*)
- Minimal personal data; no payments handled in MVP.

11. Responsible AI / guardrails

VibeHaus uses AI in three places: **Vibe Match** (recommendations), **Icebreakers**, and **Mr. Vibe** (activity-based search assistant, Stretch). Compatibility is **rule/attribute-based**; the LLM only generates the plain-language explanation, Icebreakers, and Mr. Vibe's conversational replies —

never the underlying match or search result. Every recommendation shows a **banded score + a reason listing every genuinely shared interest**, never an unexplained percentage. Mr. Vibe is deliberately **chip-only, not free-text** — testing surfaced a real reliability problem with free-text intent parsing, so the chips were expanded to cover the full interest list instead, trading flexibility for a guarantee that what's asked is what's searched. Mr. Vibe never performs real account actions and responds to distress signals with one scripted, warm line before redirecting. **Block, Report, and Remove Vibemate are built into the MVP** (not deferred), with Remove live-checked everywhere a profile can be viewed, never cached.

Full detail — data handling, human review and control, known limitations, and escalation for mistakes/abuse — lives in the standalone VibeHaus AI Responsibility Statement.

12. Light GTM

- **First channels:** expat Facebook/WhatsApp groups, Berlin subreddits, university/newcomer/coworking networks, word of mouth (reaching expats where they gather).
- **Launch assumption (v1):** a warm, expat-first, depth-oriented brand + explained AI matching earns trial and word-of-mouth better than a swipe-first competitor.
- **Expansion:** brand travels city-to-city (VibeHaus Amsterdam / Barcelona / London) once Berlin proves the loop.

13. Roadmap & release strategy

Timelines are planning assumptions for a real build with developers, not the 5-day capstone build (tracked separately in the task checklist).

Phase	Release	Adds	Timeline
1 — Now	Internal Alpha	Core Vibemate loop (onboarding, Vibe Match, Vibemate Requests, My Haus, Chat, Coffee/Activity), Events (public/private, join/invite/cancel/leave), Calendar, Mr. Vibe (chip-based), safety	Weeks 1–4 build, Week 5 alpha
2 — Validate	Closed Berlin Beta (~50–100 users)	Notifications, adaptive recommendations, language-aware matching, identity/trust, live map integration	Months 2–3

3 — Soft Launch	Waves: 10% → 25% → 50% → 100%	Same feature set, acquisition-focused, each wave Go/No-Go gated	Months 4–6
4 — Grow	Feature rollout	Full Events ecosystem enhancements, newcomer cohorts, local buddy, neighbourhood Vibes, group Vibes, advanced moderation, a fully live-generative Mr. Vibe	Months 6–9
5 — Monetize	VibeHaus+	Premium subscription, VibeHaus Hosted Experiences (paid events per §7), event booking	Months 9–12
6 — Scale	Multi-City VibeHaus	Berlin → Amsterdam/Barcelona, localization, city-level recommendations	Year 2, once Berlin shows network density

Go/No-Go per wave: product (flow reliable), user value (relevant matches, real connections), network (enough eligible matches), safety (no unresolved defects). Hold the wave if any area fails materially. *(Full detail in the backlog.)*